

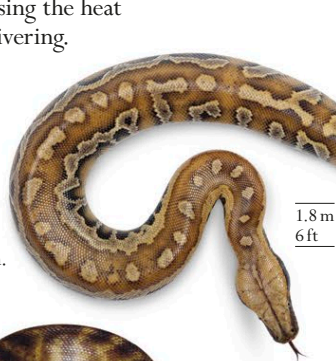
PYTHONS

Members of the family Pythonidae can be found across Africa, Asia, and Australia. Pythons detect warm-blooded prey with their facial pits. They use their mouth to grasp prey but kill by constriction. Some species coil around their eggs to help incubate them using the heat generated by their shivering.

BLOOD PYTHON

Python curtus

This relatively short python of S.E. Asian rainforests coils around its clutch of eggs to incubate and protect them.



1.8 m
6 ft

GREEN TREE PYTHON

Morelia viridis

Found in the tropical forests of Australasia, this arboreal snake spends its time looped over a branch, ready to ambush lizards and small mammals.



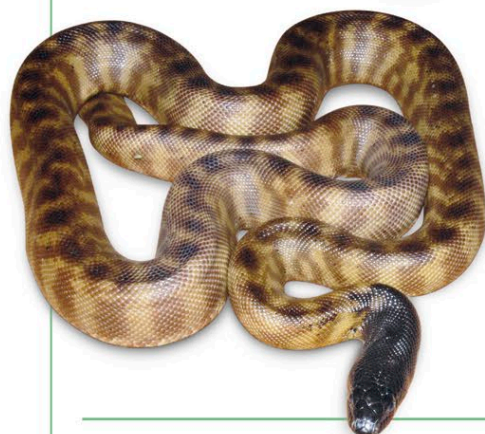
1.5 m
5 ft

bright green colour
aids in camouflage

BLACK-HEADED PYTHON

Aspidites melanocephalus

Endemic to Australia, this species is found in a variety of habitats. It preys upon other snakes and reptiles.

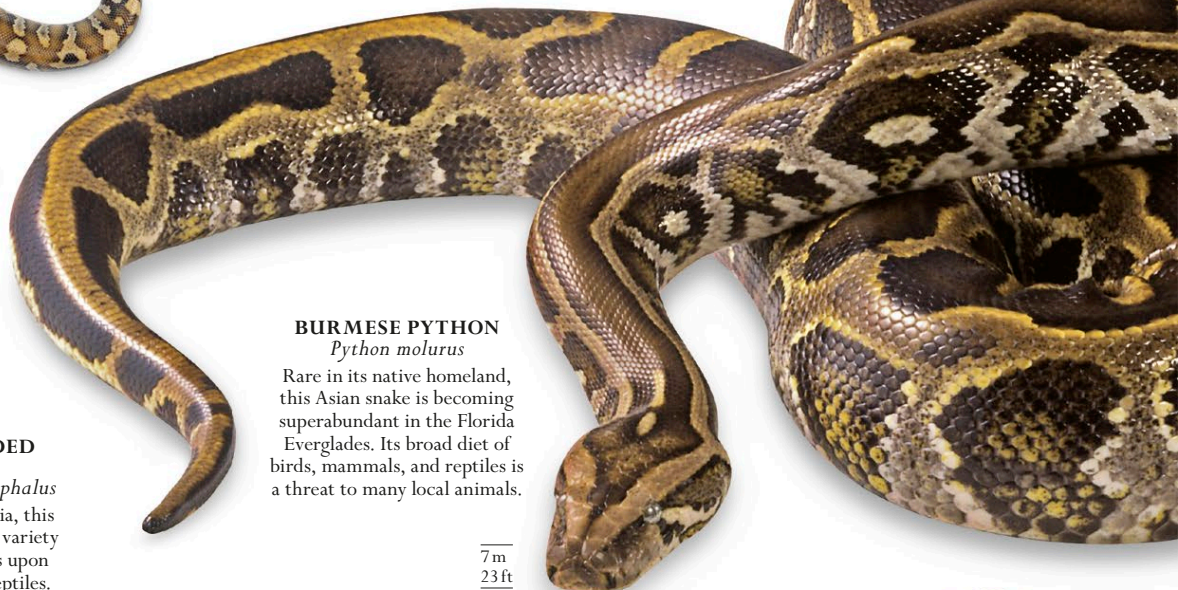


3 m
10 ft

BURMESE PYTHON

Python molurus

Rare in its native homeland, this Asian snake is becoming superabundant in the Florida Everglades. Its broad diet of birds, mammals, and reptiles is a threat to many local animals.



7 m
23 ft

BLIND SNAKES

The Typhlopidae have eyes covered with scales, rendering them effectively blind. Found in leaf litter of tropical forests, these small, burrowing snakes mainly eat soil invertebrates and have teeth only on their upper jaw. Most of them lay eggs.



35 cm
14 in

EURASIAN BLIND SNAKE

Xerotyphlops vermicularis

This worm-like blind snake from Europe inhabits dry, open areas. It burrows to feed on invertebrates, mainly ant larvae.



75 cm
30 in

BLACKISH BLIND SNAKE

Anilius nigrescens

Tough scales allow this burrowing snake from E. Australia to resist attack from ants while eating their eggs and larvae.

THREAD SNAKES

These small, slender snakes are rarely seen because of their habit of burrowing to hunt invertebrates. Belonging to the Leptotyphlopidae, they are found in the tropics of the Americas, Africa, and southwest Asia.



30 cm
12 in

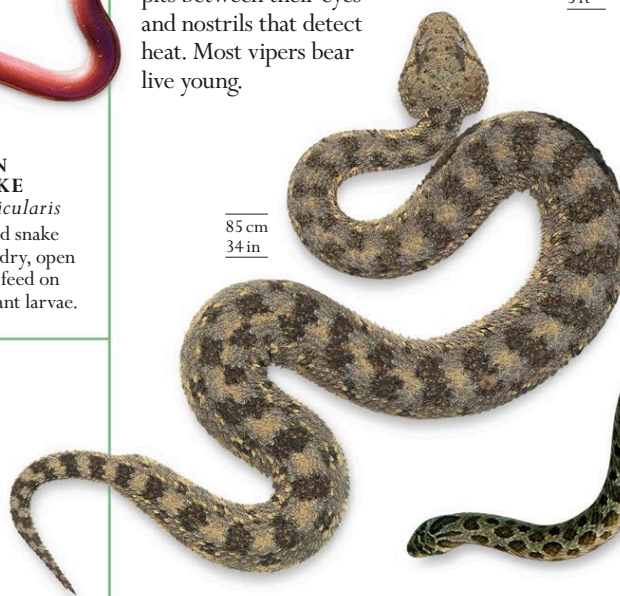
SENEGAL BLIND SNAKE

Myriopholis rouxestevae

This snake inhabits the soil of tropical forests in western Africa. First studied in 2004, it is believed to eat invertebrates.

VIPERS

The Viperidae are characterized by a thick body, keeled scales, and a triangular head. Long, tubular, hinged fangs at the front of the mouth efficiently inject venom into their vertebrate prey. Pit vipers have sensory pits between their eyes and nostrils that detect heat. Most vipers bear live young.



85 cm
34 in

DESERT HORNED VIPER

Cerastes cerastes

Occurring in the deserts of N. Africa and the Sinai Peninsula, this snake lies buried in sand to ambush small mammals and lizards.

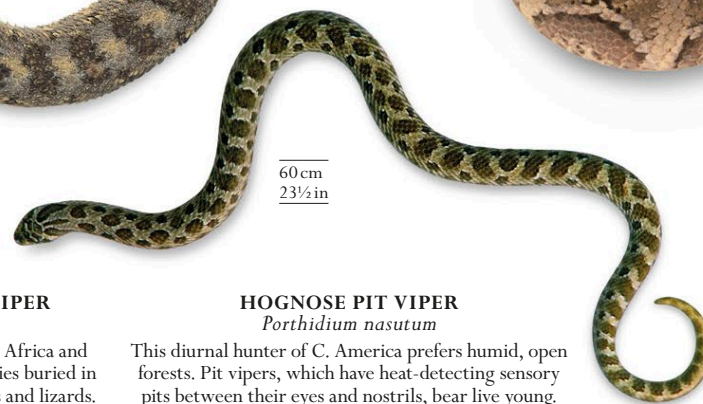


1.5 m
5 ft

FER-DE-LANCE

Bothrops atrox

Found in the forests of tropical America, this venomous snake is characterized by a sharply pointed head. It hunts birds and mammals by night.



60 cm
23 1/2 in

HOGNOSE PIT VIPER

Porthidium nasutum

This diurnal hunter of C. America prefers humid, open forests. Pit vipers, which have heat-detecting sensory pits between their eyes and nostrils, bear live young.